first chapter, we hope you don’t have the same experience, but if you do at this point, don’t worry. We’re sure everything will make sense once we start writing some test code and walking through each step in detail.

Summary

- Contract testing is a form of integration testing that verifies two connected systems have a shared understanding of expectations.
- In contract testing, interactions between two systems are presented in a contract, normally in a JSON file.
- Contract testing offers high confidence from an API integration test with a unit test’s speed and low cost.
- Contract testing can help teams find defects early without needing integrated environments.
- Contract testing is a great alternative to traditional API testing, which is difficult to manage and doesn’t scale up well, especially when working with a microservices architecture.
- Contract testing is unsuitable to verify a system’s other requirements, such as the business logic, UI, accessibility, security, or performance.
- When writing contract tests, the tests are authored by the team consuming a data service, especially in consumer-driven contract testing. The team maintaining the data service also verifies the same set of tests.
- Contract testing tools, such as Pact, help communicate changes to the contract by automatically informing the affected teams.